Design Thinking

Define Stage





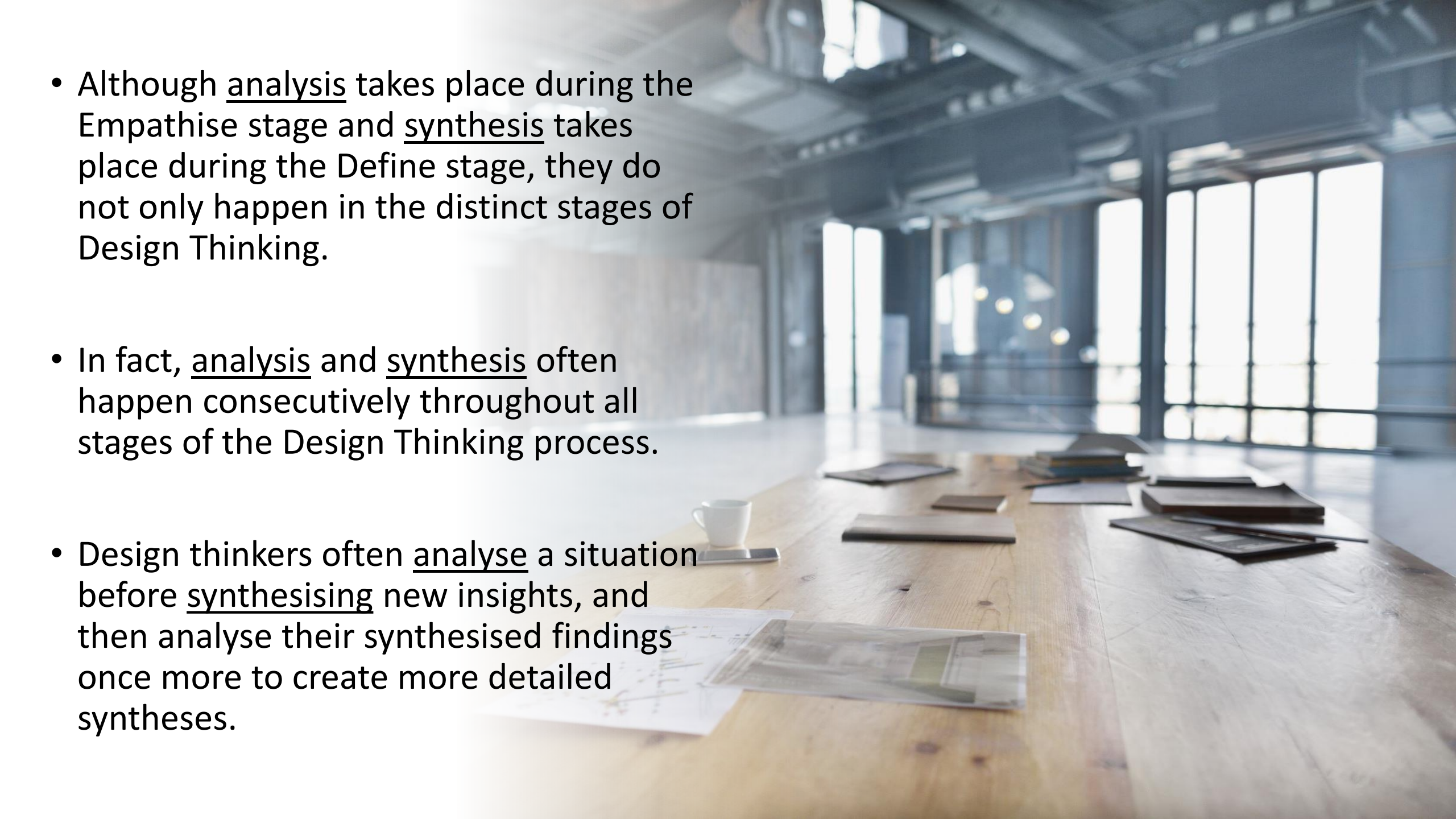
- **Synthesis**, involves creatively piecing the puzzle together to form whole ideas.
- This happens during the Define stage when we:
  - organise,
  - interpret, and
  - make sense of the data we have gathered to

  create a problem statement.

- Although analysis takes place during the Empathise stage and synthesis takes place during the Define stage, they do not only happen in the distinct stages of Design Thinking.

- In fact, analysis and synthesis often happen consecutively throughout all stages of the Design Thinking process.

- Design thinkers often analyse a situation before synthesising new insights, and then analyse their synthesised findings once more to create more detailed syntheses.



The purpose of the problem statement in design thinking?



The purpose of a problem statement is to assist those engaging in a design thinking project.



It should create a clear picture of what challenges users face and act as a guide to solve those challenges.



It is one of the most important parts of design thinking because it drives the remainder of the project.

What is a problem statement in design thinking?

A problem statement is a statement that defines the specific problem a consumer might have with a product, service, or organization.

It is a concisely written guide for finding a solution.

It should be broad enough to generate multiple solutions but narrow in scope to make the solution manageable.

Problem statement

What is an example of a problem statement?

One formula that is used to create a problem statement is (User description) needs (verb) because (a compelling insight). One example of a problem statement is:

''A new parent needs to find quick and easy ways to prepare fresh fruits and vegetables because they want to give their child nutritious food for proper growth.''

How to Define a Problem Statement?

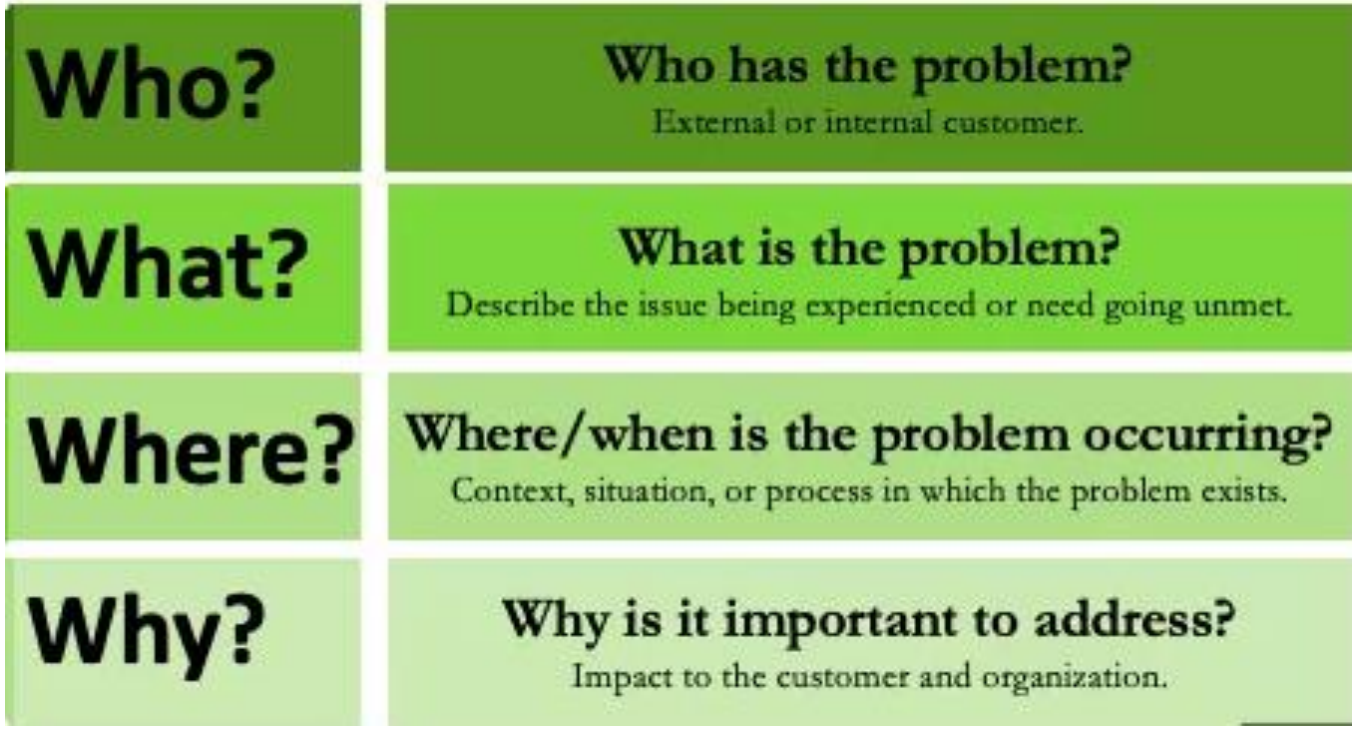
Writing a problem statement requires three things:

- a description of the user,
- a need of the user, and
- an insight

Those three parts of the problem statement should convey the ideal situation, current gaps, the consequences of the gaps, and propose finding a solution.

It should not find a solution just act as a guide to a solution.

Problem Statement



Good Problem Statements

First let's define what makes a good problem statement. These have several characteristics:

Insightful. They are based on real user needs that you've uncovered from research.

Pertinent. The problems are significant enough to warrant creating a (paid) product for. They cannot be so insignificant that most users can handle it themselves.

Many solutions. The statement should be broad enough to be potentially solved by a variety of solutions. This can be accomplished by making sure there aren't any specific solutions mentioned in the statement itself.

Directed. At the same time, the statement cannot be so broad as to become meaningless. It is important that the problem is a subset of the user's entire task.

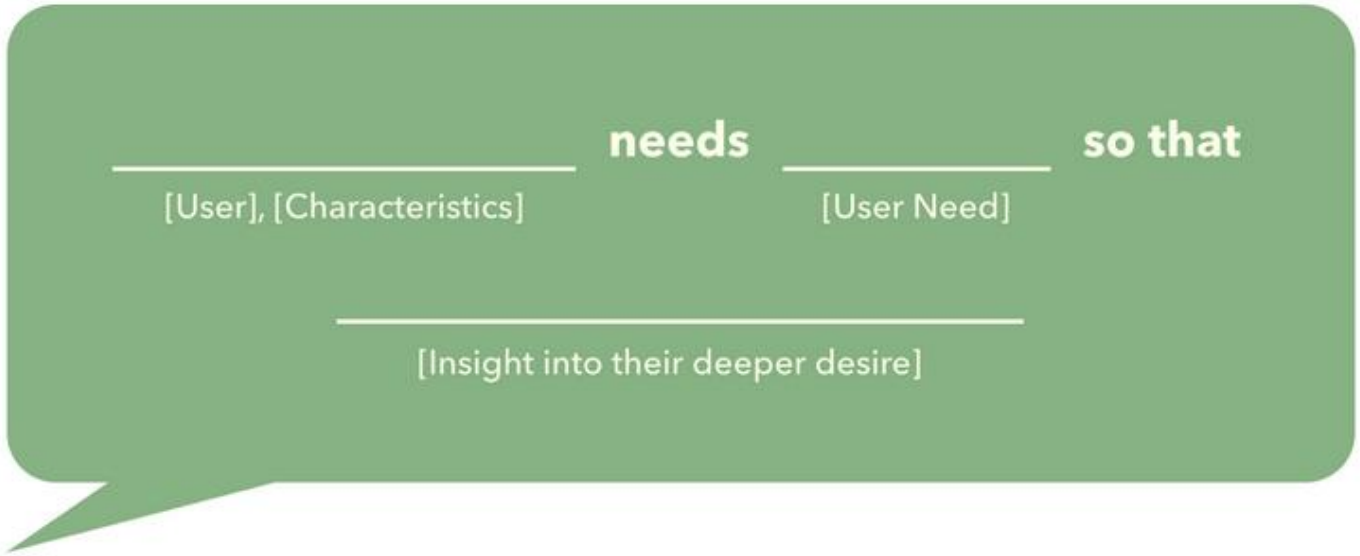
Good Problem Statements



Good Problem Statements

So in our example, the user need statement might be:

“Sarah, a driven, educated aspiring translator living in a city, needs to fi freelance work so that they can mal progress towards a life-long dream.”



Point of view: Example (*Health and student lunches*)

User: 9th grade girl at school

Need: Needs to feel socially accepted while eating healthy food. In her crew a social risk is more dangerous then a health risk.

Insights: 9th grade girl is at a new school and needs tofeel socially accepted while eating healthy food because in her crew a social risk is more dangerous then a health risk.

Persona

Sarah, a driven, educated aspiring translator living in a city

User Needs

to learn from more experienced translators

to build their reputation

to finish their degree

to learn new tools

to get freelance jobs

Insights

can make progress towards a life-long dream

Can learn the ropes of the industry

can feel competent

can feel secure about their competency

can keep improving their work

Sarah, a driven, educated aspiring translator living in a city

to learn from more experienced translators

Can learn the ropes of the industry



Sarah, a driven, educated aspiring translator living in a city

to get freelance jobs

can make progress towards a life-long dream



Making Problem Statements (aka How Might We)

- After scoping out the need we want to fulfil, we want to phrase this problem in a way that **promotes idea generation**.

- Usually we do this by forming How Might We (HMW) statements. These are sentences that begin with “How might we ….”.
- By phrasing statements this way, HMWs spark creativity and teamwork.

Making Problem Statements (aka How Might We)



‘How’ suggests that the problem is not solved yet, but it’s possible to solve it in a tangible manner.



‘Might’ means that the solution is not decided on, but we are open to exploring options.



‘We’ prompts us to think of solving it as a team, leveraging each other’s insights and skills.

There are many examples of good HMW statements. In our case, let’s use this HMW:
“HMW help Sarah learn from more experienced translators?”

For Example

- *How might we make TV more social, so youths feel more engaged?*
- *How might we enable TV programs to be watched anywhere, at anytime?*
- *How might we make watching TV at home more exciting?*
- The HMW questions open up to Ideation sessions where you explore ideas, which can help you solve your design challenge in an innovative way.